

Report on the Activities and Functions of the Department of Statistics: Central and Kerala State Governments

1 Central Government Level: MoSPI and NSO

The Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI), operating via the **National Statistical Office (NSO)**, is the primary national custodian of official socio-economic data. Its foundational activities are organized into distinct functional domains:

- **Macroeconomic Indicators:** NSO compiles critical economic aggregates, including the quarterly and annual **Gross Domestic Product (GDP)**, Gross Value Added (GVA), and national income accounts. It compiles the monthly **Index of Industrial Production (IIP)** to track manufacturing output alongside the Consumer Price Index (CPI) to measure inflation.
- **Socio-Economic Sample Surveys:** Through the National Sample Survey Office (NSSO), MoSPI routinely launches specialized large-scale surveys. Prominent active surveys include the **Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS)** for employment patterns, the **Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (HCES)**, and the **Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (ASUSE)**.
- **Digital Modernization & Data Reuse:** MoSPI has successfully shifted to electronic collection platforms via Computer-Assisted Personal Interviewing (**CAPI**) and the **e-SIGMA** data architecture. Current initiatives emphasize harmonizing departmental datasets across states to facilitate advanced cross-agency data reuse and interoperability.

2 State Government Level: DES Kerala

Operating under the Department of Planning and Economic Affairs, the **Directorate of Economics and Statistics (DES), Kerala**, functions as the definitive nerve center for regional data collection. Headquartered with 14 District Statistical Offices and 61 Taluk Statistical Offices, its primary actions feature:

- **Agricultural and Crop Statistics:** Under the **Establishment of an Agency for Reporting Agricultural Statistics (EARAS)** scheme, the department rigorously documents seasonal crop area, yield estimates, and land utilization patterns. It also oversees the complex **Cost of Cultivation Survey** for critical cash and staple crops native to the state.

- **Price Monitoring and Local Indices:** DES Kerala tracks market dynamics across urban and rural pockets. It releases regional **Consumer Price Indices (CPI)**, daily/monthly essential commodity price metrics, and specialized wage structure analysis to safeguard labor welfare and guide state market interventions.
- **Federal Collaboration:** The directorate directly executes central initiatives inside Kerala, conducting state-level parallel matching samples for the National Sample Survey (NSS), the quinquennial **Agricultural Census**, and the multi-sectoral **Economic Census**.